Maria Thurn

Gammel Køge Landevej 22A, 3. 3 2500 Copenhagen
mariathurn@web.de
+45 71 58 91 18
www.linkedin.com/in/maria-thurn-134421142



Personal Profile

Recent MSc IT & Cognition graduate with hands-on experience in frontend development, full-stack web applications, and AI/NLP projects. Experienced with React, TypeScript, TailwindCSS, Node.js, Express, REST APIs, Python, and machine learning workflows. I enjoy building clean, intuitive user interfaces and turning technical ideas into structured, maintainable software. With a background in design, cognitive science, and AI, I bring both technical and user-centered perspectives to product development and am motivated to grow in a fast-moving AI product team.

Qualifications

Technical Skills

- **Programming**: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, C#, C++
- **Frontend**: React, TypeScript, JavaScript, TailwindCSS, HTML, CSS
- **Backend**: REST APIs, Node.js, Express.js
- **AI / Data**: Machine Learning, NLP, Transformers, Named Entity Recognition, Data Analysis, Pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn
- **Tools**: Git, GitHub, VS Code, Jupyter Notebook, Google Colab
- **Methods**: Debugging, Agile teamwork, project documentation

Project Skills

- Combine technical, AI, and user-centered perspectives to solve complex problems.
- Communicate clearly and collaborate effectively in team-based projects.

Projects

Pet Adoption & Food Store – Full-Stack Web Application

GitHub: https://github.com/mariathurn/petAdoption-main

- Collaborated in a student team to develop a full-stack web application for pet adoption and e-commerce using React, TypeScript, Node.js, and Express.
- Built responsive frontend components with React, TypeScript, and TailwindCSS.
- Developed and integrated REST API endpoints for application features.
- Implemented backend services in Node.js and Express using a mock JSON-based database.
- Used Git-based collaboration, debugging, testing, and agile development practices.

Master's Thesis: Cross-lingual Representation and Explainability of Named Entities

GitHub: https://github.com/mariathurn/multilingual-ner-thesis

- Fine-tuned and evaluated multilingual Transformer models for Named Entity Recognition.
- Compared XLM-R and mT5 using Python, Hugging Face Transformers, PyTorch, and NLP evaluation metrics.
- Analyzed multilingual embedding spaces to evaluate cross-lingual representation alignment.
- Applied Integrated Gradients to compare model behavior and token attribution patterns.

2D Survival Game – Unity/C#

Play: https://mariagamingcorner.itch.io/donut-wars

- Built a 2D survival game in Unity using C# and object-oriented programming.
- Developed player, enemy, weapon, UI, audio, and game management systems with clear separation of responsibilities and component-based architecture.
- Integrated audio, animation, physics, collision detection, and UI systems within the Unity engine.

Education

University of Copenhagen
08/2024 – 07/2026

Master of Science in IT and Cognition

Interdisciplinary program combining computer science, artificial intelligence, and cognitive science. The program focuses on machine learning, natural language processing, and human-computer interaction.

Maastricht University
02/2022 – 07/2024

Bachelor of Liberal Arts and Sciences, University College Maastricht

Interdisciplinary specialization in the Sciences and Social Sciences, with a focus on Psychology and Neuroscience. In my Bachelor thesis I assessed the use of Ketogenic Diet on mental health, by means of literature review.

Maastricht University
10/2020 – 07/2021

Bachelor of Science in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence

COMPLETED 56 ECTS BEFORE TRANSFERRING TO ANOTHER PROGRAM

Learned the basics of programming, mathematics and computer science. Worked on multiple programming group projects.

Nuremberg Institute of Technology
10/2015 – 03/2020

Bachelor of Arts in Design

Main subjects: 3D, Photography, Verbal Communication, Typography. Bachelor thesis: "Designing a barefoot shoe in 3D".

Employment history

University of Copenhagen
09/2025 – 01/2026

Teaching Assistant

- Mentored students in Python, debugging, and code review
- Explained programming concepts to students with different experience levels

Mercedes-Benz CSC
Maastricht
08/2021 – 02/2023

Customer Service Representative

- Provided technical support via phone and email
- Resolved issues related to mobile applications and in-car systems

Siemens Healthineers
Erlangen, Germany
08/2019 – 03/2020

3D Visualisation Designer

- Designed and built a full-scale virtual reality exhibition hall in 3ds Max
- Created product models and supported testing of the VR experience

Adidas
Herzogenaurach, Germany
08/2019 – 03/2020

3D Design Intern, Digital Creation

- Created 3D footwear prototypes and evaluated new digital tools for integration into designers' workflows

Languages

- Danish Module 3 completed
- English professional working proficiency
- German mother tongue
- Japanese beginner

Additional Information & Hobbies

In my free time, I volunteer at a local community kitchen in Valby, where I enjoy meeting people from different backgrounds and learning recipes from around the world. I also enjoy sewing clothes, Lindy Hop dancing, and improvisational theatre.